AUTNES
AUSTRIAN NATIONAL ELECTION STUDY

AUTNES Comparative Study of Electoral Systems Post-Election Survey 2017 Documentation

(SUF Edition v1.0.0, 2018)

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AUTNES Comparative Study of Electoral Systems Post-Election Survey 2017 – Documentation (SUF Edition)

(September 2018)

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Suggested citation for the documentation:

Julian Aichholzer, Sylvia Kritzinger, Markus Wagner, Nicolai Berk, Hajo Boomgaarden & Wolfgang C. Müller (2018). *AUTNES Comparative Study of Electoral Systems Post-Election Survey 2017 – Documentation (SUF Edition)*. Vienna: AUSSDA (doi:10.11587/IMKDZI).

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1 Introduction

This report accompanies the Comparative Study of Electoral Systems Post-Election Survey 2017 (doi:10.11587/IMKDZI) conducted by the *Austrian National Election Study* (AUTNES) and provides a detailed documentation of the data collection.

The survey's questionnaire is based on the *Comparative Study of Electoral Systems* (CSES) Module 5 and focuses on the Austrian National Parliamentary Election held on 15 October 2017.[1] The questionnaire was extended by country-specific and other relevant questions which are covered in this version (SUF Edition).

1.1 How to cite these data

Data users are kindly asked to acknowledge the data and the accompanying release document (Documentation). Please refer to the Austrian Social Science Data Archive - AUSSDA for a recommendation on how to cite these data.

1.2 Changes in Editions

(No changes.)

2 Conditions of Use

2.1 Restrictions

The data are available for scientific use without restrictions.

2.2 Confidentiality

The AUTNES, its Principal Investigators, and the funding institutions neither take responsibility for the use of the data or interpretations and inferences based on their use, nor do they accept liability for indirect, consequential, or incidental damages or losses arising from use of the data.

2.3 Deposit Requirement

In order to facilitate exchange within the scientific community and to provide the funding agencies with essential information about the use of archival resources, users of the AUTNES data are asked to notify the AUTNES team of publications based on its data.

3 Study Description

3.1 Title and Edition

AUTNES Comparative Study of Electoral Systems Post-Election Survey 2017 – Documentation (SUF Edition)

3.2 Principal Investigators

Wolfgang C. Müller, Department of Government, University of Vienna (Supply Side)

Sylvia Kritzinger, Department of Government, University of Vienna (Demand Side)

Hajo Boomgaarden, Department of Communication, University of Vienna (Media Side)

[1] Url: http://www.cses.org/collabs/CSES_Module5_Questionnaire.txt

3.3 Funding / Acknowledgments

This study was funded by ACIER – *Austrian Cooperative Infrastructure for Electoral Research* financed by the Federal Ministry of Science, Research and Economy (BMWFW) [Scheme: Hochschulraum-Strukturmittel 2016].

3.4 Fieldwork agency

The fieldwork for the AUTNES Comparative Study of Electoral Systems Post-Election Survey 2017 was conducted by IPR Umfrageforschung, Dr. Richard Költringer (Rathausstraße 13, A-1010 Vienna), Url: http://www.ipr.co.at

3.5 File Names

"10013_mr_en_v1_0.pdf" (Method report and codebook)

"10013_qu_en_v1_0.pdf" (Questionnaire English)

"10013_qu_de_v1_0.pdf" (Questionnaire German)

"10013_om_en_v1_0.tab" (Variable identifiers and descriptions – machine-readable English)

"10013_om_de_v1_0.tab" (Variable identifiers and descriptions – machine-readable German)

"10013_da_en_v1_0.dta" (Stata data file English)

"10013_da_de_v1_0.dta" (Stata data file German)

"10013_da_en_v1_0.sav" (SPSS data file English)

"10013_da_de_v1_0.sav" (SPSS data file German)

3.6 Topics / Keywords

Comparative Study of Electoral Systems (CSES), politics, voting, elections, Austria

4 Study Design

4.1 Sampling

The population universe comprises eligible voters for the Austrian Parliamentary Election on 15 October 2017 (Austrian citizens, aged 16 years and older at election day).

In total, n = 1203 interviews were successfully completed. Excluding non-eligible cases, this results in a response rate of 43.3%.

Table 1: Sample size and response rate

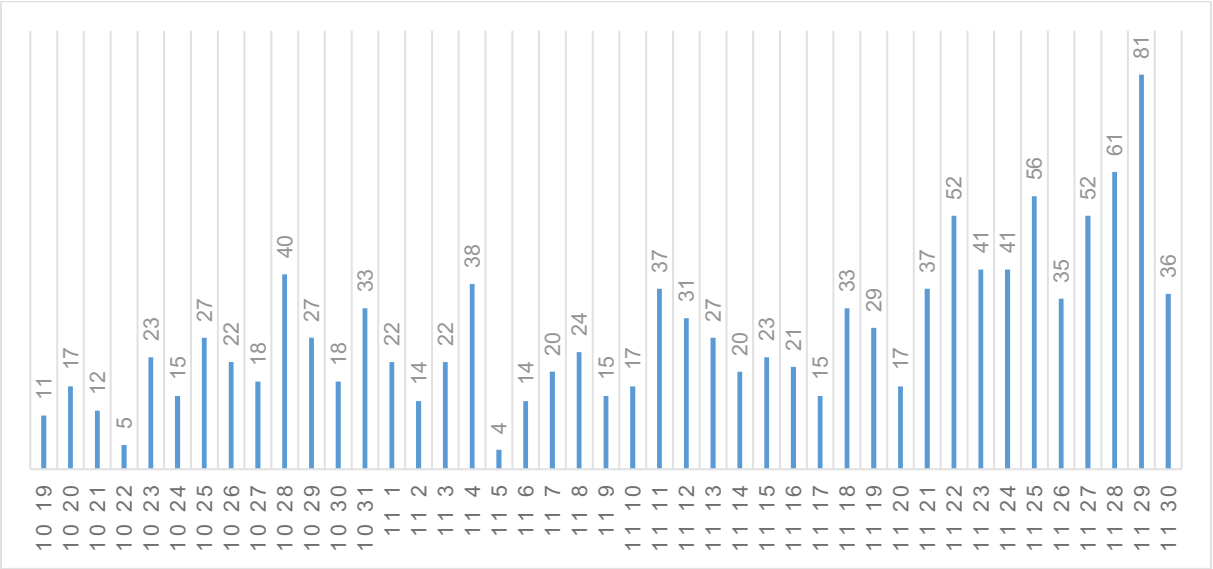
	total	in %
Initial gross sample	**3600**	**100.0**
Incorrect/Non-working number (RDD)	702	19.5
Non-target person	119	3.3
Initial net sample	**2779**	**100.0**
Respondent never available	954	34.3
Refusal	622	22.4
Successful interviews (response rate)	**1203**	**43.3**

4.2 Fieldwork

The survey was administered by means of computer-assisted telephone interviewing (CATI). Of the final sample (n = 1203) 49.0% were reached via mobile phone and 51.0% via landline.

The survey was designed as a cross-sectional sample. The fieldwork took place between 19 October and 30 November 2017 (43 days in total, see Figure 1).

Figure 1: Number of interviews conducted per day (format: month/day)



In total, 22 interviewers (12 female, 10 male) conducted the survey who administered between 1 and 200 interviews (see Table 2).

Table 2: Interviewer workload

ID	No. of interviews
98	1
111	1
10	9
12	12
43	20
9	21
62	21
61	22
3	24
51	25
65	28
377	30
52	33
54	33
37	34
63	35
399	53
13	117
19	131
11	155
315	198
211	200
Total	**1203**

5 Data Cleaning

5.1 Data Protection

Any information on the respondents' residence, such as postal codes (question "D18") and the regional constituency (**regwk**), had to be removed for reasons of data protection. However, we use the postal codes to merge the categorized population number in the municipality (**popnum**).

To further anonymize the data, we drop the month of birh (question "D01a"), but the data set still contains the year of birth (question "D01b"). We add an additional variable **age** indicating the respondent's age on election day.

We also recoded demographic information from the following variables in order to prevent the identification of respondents:

- **Education** (d03). We collapsed the original categories 1 ("did not attend school"), 2 ("did not finish school") and category 3 ("elementary school or less") and added a new variable (d03c).
- **Religious denomination** (d10). We recoded the religious affiliation into a new variable (d10c) collapsing category the category 2000 ("Jewish") with category 9600 ("other").
- **Country of birth** (d14). We recoded the country of birth into a new variable (d14c) with five categories: (1) Austria, (2) Germany, (3) Croatia, Serbia, Bosnia, (4) Poland, Slovenia, Czech Republic, Hungary, and (5) other countries (including among others also Turkey and Russia).
- **Household size** (d20): We recoded household size into a new variable (d20c) collapsing households with 6, 7, or 8 household members into one category of "6 or more people" members.

5.2 Variable format and missing values

All missing values were coded according to the questionnaire. In general, missing values are coded as follows:

- Don't know party/person or invalid/ineligible= 66
- Refused = 77
- Don't know = 88

6 Weighting of data

Weights are calculated for post-stratification adjustment according to known population distributions (listed in Table 3) and were provided by the survey institute (IPR). The weighting variable combines demographic and political criteria (i.e., vote recall for the 2017 election). We provide:

- An original or rough weight: "gew_roh"
- A trimmed (winsorized) weight: "gew"

The values of the rough weighting variable ranges between Min = 0.12 and Max= 9.97, the latter weighting variable limits the values to Min ≈ 0.4 and Max ≈ 2.5.

Table 3. Comparison of key characteristics in the sample and population

Variable	**Sample**	**Population**
GENDER (=d02)		
Male	49.6%	48.9%
Female	50.4%	51.1%
AGE rough (=d01a & d01b recoded)		
Aged 16-45	40.6%	41.6%
Older than 45	59.4%	58.4%
AGE detailed (=d01a & d01b recoded)		
16-19	3.1%	5.0%
20-29	14.2%	14.1%
30-39	13.7%	13.9%
40-49	17.3%	16.9%
50-59	20.6%	18.7%
60-69	16.0%	13.6%
70+	15.1%	17.7%
AGE X EDUCATION		
Aged 16-45 w/Matura	23.9%	15.7%
Aged 16-45, no Matura	16.7%	25.9%
Older than 45 w/Matura	21.2%	12.5%
Older than 45, no Matura	38.2%	45.9%
GENDER X EDUCATION		
Female w/Matura	22.7%	14.7%
Female, no Matura	27.7%	36.4%
Male w/Matura	22.4%	13.5%
Male, no Matura	27.3%	35.4%
REGION (=d17)		
Burgenland	3.0%	3.7%
Carinthia	7.2%	6.9%
Lower Austria	20.5%	20.2%
Upper Austria	13.5%	17.3%
Salzburg	5.9%	6.1%
Styria	13.3%	15.2%
Tyrol	6.9%	8.5%
Vorarlberg	4.8%	4.2%
Vienna	24.9%	18.0%
HOUSEHOLD SIZE (=d20 recoded)		
1 person	21.9%	20.2%
2 persons	35.6%	32.1%
3 or more persons	41.1%	47.7%
refused	1.4%	--
EDUCATION (=d03 recoded)		
No school, primary school, lower secondary level (incl. Pre-vocational school)	14.2%	21.4%
Vocational training/school	26.8%	37.0%
Higher vocational school (BMS)	14.0%	13.5%
Secondary school leaving certificate ("Matura")	27.6%	15.4%
Tertiary education	17.5%	12.8%
EMPLOYMENT (=D06)		
Working (Codes 1-3)	60.6%	52.5%
Retired (Code 7)	27.1%	28.7%
Pupil, Student (Code 6, excl. in vocational training)	6.3%	7.1%
Other (other Codes)	6.0%	11.7%
VOTE RECALL 2017 incl. non-voters as category (=q12a & q12b)		
Non-Voter	6.3%	20.0%
SPÖ	22.9%	21.3%
ÖVP	33.3%	24.9%
FPÖ	18.0%	20.6%
The Greens	4.2%	3.0%
NEOS	4.4%	4.2%
List Pilz	5.6%	3.5%
Other/invalid	5.3%	2.5%

(Source: Statistik Austria, Mikrozensus 2016; Election results: https://wahl17.bmi.gv.at/)

7 Variable list

Variable	Variable label
noresp	ID COMPONENT - RESPONDENT WITHIN ELECTION STUDY
month	DATE QUESTIONNAIRE ADMINISTERED - MONTH
year	DATE QUESTIONNAIRE ADMINISTERED - YEAR
day	DATE QUESTIONNAIRE ADMINISTERED - DAY
c1	MOBILE PHONE OR LANDLINE
c2	LANDLINE AT HOME
c3	USES ANOTHER MOBILE PHONE
c4	OWNS MOBILE PHONE
gew_roh	ORIGINAL WEIGHT: DEMOGRAPHIC + POLITICAL (ROUGH)
gew	ORIGINAL WEIGHT: DEMOGRAPHIC+ POLITICAL (TRIMMED)
intnr	INTERVIEWER WITHIN ELECTION STUDY
intsex	INTERVIEWER GENDER
d01b	DATE OF BIRTH OF RESPONDENT - YEAR
age	AGE (ON ELECTION DAY)
q01	POLITICAL INTEREST
q02	POLITICS IN THE MEDIA
q03	INTERNAL EFFICACY
q04a	ATTITUDES ABOUT ELITES: COMPROMISE
q04b	ATTITUDES ABOUT ELITES: DO NOT CARE ABOUT THE PEOPLE
q04c	ATTITUDES ABOUT ELITES: ARE TRUSTWORTHY
q04d	ATTITUDES ABOUT ELITES: ARE THE MAIN PROBLEM
q04e	ATTITUDES ABOUT ELITES: STRONG LEADER BENDS THE RULES
q04f	ATTITUDES ABOUT ELITES: PEOPLE SHOULD MAKE POLICY DECISIONS
q04g	ATTITUDES ABOUT ELITES: RICH AND POWERFUL
q04h	OPINION: PREFER INDEPENDENT CITIZEN INSTEAD OF A PARTY MEMBER
q04i	OPINION: CORPORATIONS AND NOT THE GOVERNMENT DECIDE OVER POLITICS
q05a	OUT-GROUP ATTITUDES: MINORITIES - CUSTOMS AND TRADITIONS
q05b	OUT-GROUP ATTITUDES: MINORITIES - WILL OF THE MAJORITY
q05c	OUT-GROUP ATTITUDES: IMMIGRANTS GOOD FOR ECONOMY
q05d	OUT-GROUP ATTITUDES: CULTURE HARMED BY IMMIGRANTS
q05e	OUT-GROUP ATTITUDES: IMMIGRANTS INCREASE CRIME
q05f	OPINION: IMMIGRANTS TAKE AWAY AUSTRIAN JOBS
q05g	OPINION: IMMIGRANTS PAY MORE INTO THE SOCIAL SECURITY SYSTEM
q05h	OPINION: IMMIGRANTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO MAINTAIN TRADITIONS
q05i	OPINION: IMMIGRATION HAS NO IMPACT ON TERROR RISK
q06a	NATIONAL IDENTITY: TO HAVE BEEN BORN IN COUNTRY
q06b	NATIONAL IDENTITY: ANCESTRY
q06c	NATIONAL IDENTITY: TO BE ABLE TO SPEAK COUNTRY LANGUAGES
q06d	NATIONAL IDENTITY: TO FOLLOW CUSTOMS AND TRADITIONS COUNTRY
q06e	NATIONAL IDENTITY: LIVING IN AUSTRIA
q06f	NATIONAL IDENTITY: RESPECT INSTITUTIONS

Variable	Variable label
q06g	NATIONAL IDENTITY: FEELING AUSTRIAN
q06h	NATIOANL IDENTITY: CHRITIANITY
q07	HOW WIDESPREAD IS CORRUPTION
q08	GOVERNMENT ACTION - DIFFERENCES IN INCOME LEVELS
q08a	OPINION: WELFARE STATE MAKES PEOPLE IDLE AND LAZY
q08b	OPINION: FIGHT UNEMPLOYMENT, EVEN AT EXPENSE OF HIGH NATIONAL DEBT
q08c	OPINION: INCOME DIFFERENCES ARE TOO LARGE IN AUSTRIA
q08d	OPINION: EVERY SOCIETY NEEDS SOME ON TOP AND ON THE BOTTOM
q08e	OPINION: NO SOCIAL GROUP SHOULD HAVE PRIVILEGES
q08f	OPINION: UNJUST TRYING TO MAKE ALL GROUPS EQUAL
q08g	OPINION: EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES FOR ALL GROUPS
q09	GOVERNMENT PERFORMANCE: GENERAL
q10a	IS THERE A PARTY THAT REPRESENTS RESPONDENT'S VIEWS
q10b	PARTY THAT REPRESENTS RESPONDENT'S VIEWS BEST
q11	STATE OF ECONOMY
q12a	CURRENT LOWER HOUSE ELECTION: DID RESPONDENT CAST A BALLOT
q12c	CURRENT LOWER HOUSE ELECTION: DID RESPONDENT CAST CANDIDATE PREFERENCE
q12b	CURRENT LOWER HOUSE ELECTION: VOTE CHOICE - PARTY LIST VOTE
q12d1	PREFERENCE VOTE: REGIONAL LIST
q12d2	PREFERENCE VOTE: STATE LIST
q12d3	PREFERENCE VOTE: FEDERAL LIST
q12d4	PREFERENCE VOTE: DID NOT CAST
q12d5	PREFERENCE VOTE: DON'T KNOW
q12d6	PREFERENCE VOTE: REFUSED
q14a	WHO IS IN POWER CAN MAKE A BIG DIFFERENCE
q14b	WHO PEOPLE VOTE FOR MAKES A BIG DIFFERENCE
q13a	PREVIOUS ELECTION: DID RESPONDENT CAST A BALLOT
q13b	PREVIOUS ELECTION: VOTE CHOICE - PARTY LIST
q15a	LIKE-DISLIKE: SPOE
q15b	LIKE-DISLIKE: OEVP
q15c	LIKE-DISLIKE: FPOE
q15d	LIKE-DISLIKE: GREENS
q15e	LIKE-DISLIKE: NEOS
q15f	LIKE-DISLIKE: LIST PILZ
q16a	LIKE-DISLIKE: Christian Kern (SPOE)
q16b	LIKE-DISLIKE: Sebastian Kurz (OEVP)
q16c	LIKE-DISLIKE: Heinz-Christian Strache (FPOE)
q16d	LIKE-DISLIKE: Ulrike Lunacek (GREENS)
q16e	LIKE-DISLIKE: Matthias Strolz (NEOS)
q16f	LIKE-DISLIKE: Peter Pilz (LIST PILZ)
q17a	LEFT-RIGHT: SPOE
q17b	LEFT-RIGHT: OEVP
q17c	LEFT-RIGHT: FPOE
q17d	LEFT-RIGHT: GREENS
q17e	LEFT-RIGHT: NEOS

Variable	Variable label
q17f	LEFT-RIGHT: LIST PILZ
q18	LEFT-RIGHT - SELF
q21	SATISFACTION WITH DEMOCRATIC PROCESS
q22a	ARE YOU CLOSE TO ANY POLITICAL PARTY
q22b	DO YOU FEEL CLOSER TO ONE PARTY
q22c	WHICH PARTY DO YOU FEEL CLOSEST TO
q22d	DEGREE OF CLOSENESS TO THIS PARTY
f1	ATTENTIVENESS TO SILBERSTEIN SCANDAL
f2	INFLUENCE ON VOTE CHOICE: SILBERSTEIN SCANDAL
f3	INITIAL VOTE CHOICE: SILBERSTEIN SCANDAL
f4	BEHAVIOR OF SPOE: SILBERSTEIN SCANDAL
f5	BEHAVIOR OF OEVP: SILBERSTEIN SCANDAL
d02	GENDER
d03c	EDUCATION - RECODED
d04	MARITAL OR CIVIL UNION STATUS
d05	UNION MEMBERSHIP
d06	CURRENT EMPLOYMENT STATUS
d07a	SOCIO ECONOMIC STATUS
d07	MAIN OCCUPATION
d08	EMPLOYMENT TYPE - PUBLIC OR PRIVATE
d09	HOUSEHOLD INCOME
d10c	RELIGIOUS DENOMINATION - RECODED
d11	RELIGIOUS SERVICES ATTENDANCE
d14c	COUNTRY OF BIRTH - RECODED
d15	WAS EITHER BIOLOGICAL PARENT BORN OUTSIDE OF THE COUNTRY
d20c	NUMBER IN HOUSEHOLD - RECODED
d16	LANGUAGE USUALLY SPOKEN AT HOME OTHER THAN GERMAN
d17	REGION OF RESIDENCE
d19	RURAL OR URBAN RESIDENCE
popnum	POPULATION NUMBER (MUNICIPALITY)